

India Autos

India Autos: The hybrid inflection - who's positioned?



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India's strong-hybrid market is still nascent, but why is it so small, and are we close to an inflection? We tackle both questions, along with positioning, in this report.

India has, almost inadvertently, stress-tested hybrid demand: ~8 strong hybrid models versus 35-40 BEVs. Larger hybrids (>4m) are taxed at 40%, no different from large ICE SUVs, while EVs sit at 5%. There is no central subsidy, and the only meaningful state support (UP road tax waiver) lapsed in Oct'25. Yet strong-hybrid sales still grew 85%+ in 2025, outpacing BEVs. That is what genuine product-market fit looks like, even with clear gaps in the lineup. As OEMs fill those gaps, model proliferation should unlock the next leg.

We see strong hybrids scaling from ~2.3% of PVs today to 7–8% by 2030, driven by a near-doubling of the model catalog by FY28, policy notwithstanding. The 40% GST wall and improving BEV economics are real risks, so our conviction is deliberately anchored to the back half of the decade. Through FY30, as supply unlocks, the beneficiaries should be those most exposed to this ramp.

Our arguments:

(a) Nascency reflects supply, not demand. 83% growth in 2025 from just eight models, taxed at 40% and unsubsidized, is a clear revealed-preference signal. Products that do not resonate do not scale like this.

(b) The key constraint, model availability, eases in FY28. A launch wave (Maruti's in-house series-HEV across Fronx, then Swift/Baleno; Hyundai Creta hybrid; Kia Seltos hybrid; Renault Duster E-Tech; Mahindra XUV 3XO) more than doubles the lineup and targets the ₹1-2.5mn sweet spot. Maruti is not waiting on policy: in the Victoris, features like panoramic sunroof, 360° camera, ADAS, and ventilated seats are reserved for the hybrid top trim, a clear nudge to mix.

(c) The tax wall is real. GST 2.0 keeps hybrids aligned with ICE (40% for large, 18% for small). While current Maruti models are at 40%, several upcoming models should qualify for 18%, widening the gap versus EVs. Our thesis does not rely on policy turning favorable.

(d) Residuals and running costs remain underappreciated. Hybrids depreciate ~35% over five years versus >60% for BEVs and avoid charging constraints. In a fast-formalizing used-car market, that predictability is a structural tailwind.

(e) Global signals support demand but flag policy risk. Hybrids have outpaced BEVs in the US, EU, and Japan as subsidies fade, but China shows policy can effectively switch off a powertrain. India is different, but not immune.

(f) We are constructive through FY30, not indefinitely. Falling BEV costs are the long-term risk, though bounded. States like Kerala and Karnataka are already rolling back EV tax benefits, limiting any meaningful convergence before 2030.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	12 Jun 2026		Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
		Cur	Closing Price			Cur	2026A	2027E	2028E	2026A	2027E	2028E
MSIL.IN (Maruti Suzuki)	O	INR	13,366	18,200	(33.1)%	INR	459.46	468.95	531.43	29.1	28.5	25.2
MM.IN (Mahindra & Mahindra)	O	INR	3,042.90	4,200.00	(39.6)%	INR	126.00	148.62	168.58	24.2	20.5	18.1
ASIAAX			1,966.72									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We are **Outperform** on Maruti Suzuki and M&M.

Maruti has built powertrain optionality on purpose: its FY31 ambition points to ~35% CNG/CBG, ~25% ICE, ~25% and 15% EV - mix that is engineered to win whichever of those powertrain actually penetrates. It does not need to be right about the powertrain war. It needs only for the war to be fought.

EXHIBIT 1: **Maruti's stated powertrain mix ambition by FY30/31**



Source: Company data, Bernstein analysis

The decisive move is the in-house series-hybrid system, debuting on the Fronx in 2027 and spreading to the Swift and Baleno. It does two things at once. It strips out the Toyota licensing cost that has kept strong hybrids at a premium-SUV price point. And by targeting 35+ kmpl in a sub-4m body that already qualifies for the 18% small-car GST slab, it drags the strong hybrid down toward INR 1-1.5mn - into the heart of the market for the first time. That is the catalog expansion and the price unlock in a single product.

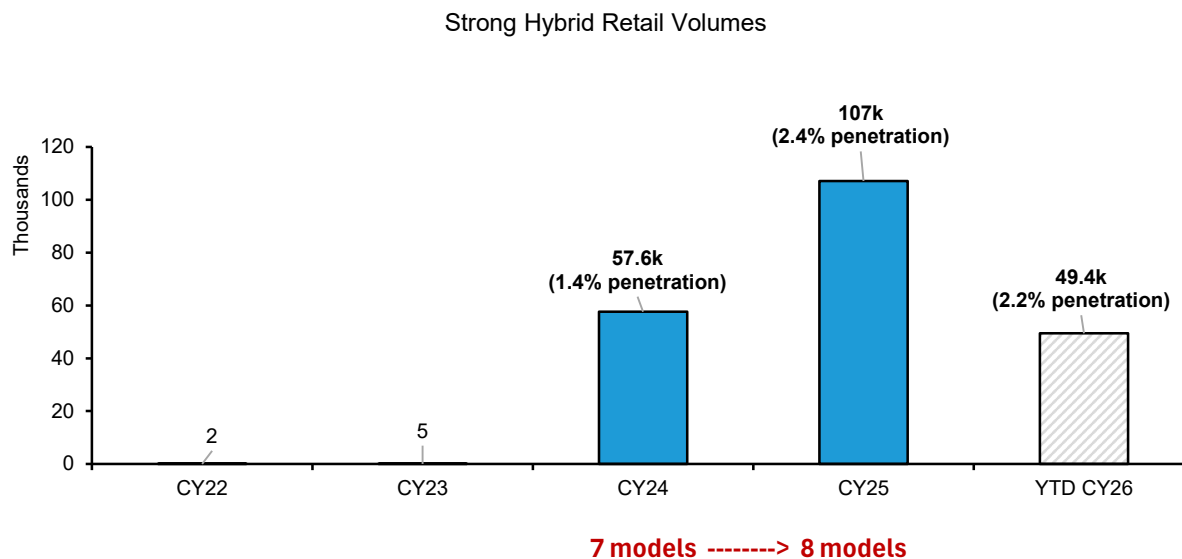
Mahindra is the more interesting problem. It has been the loudest EV-first voice in the room: it classifies hybrids under “petrol,” and it opposed hybrid incentives. Their posture and position is clear. Hence, if Hybrids inflect more in the coming years vs BEVs, their huge EV bet might look early.

But Mahindra is not all unhedged, and pretending otherwise would be lazy. It is developing a strong-hybrid XUV 3XO for 2026 (tentative) and range-extenders for the BE 6 and XEV 9e - a deliberate straddle that lets it pivot if the data turns. Hence, its hybrid hedge is real but later and thinner than Maruti's, and its public EV conviction raises the cost of being wrong. Hence, the performance would be asymmetric to the downside if hybrids inflect on schedule, vindicated if Chinese-style BEV cost declines arrive first.

DETAILS

INDIA BUYS AS MANY HYBRIDS AS IT IS OFFERED

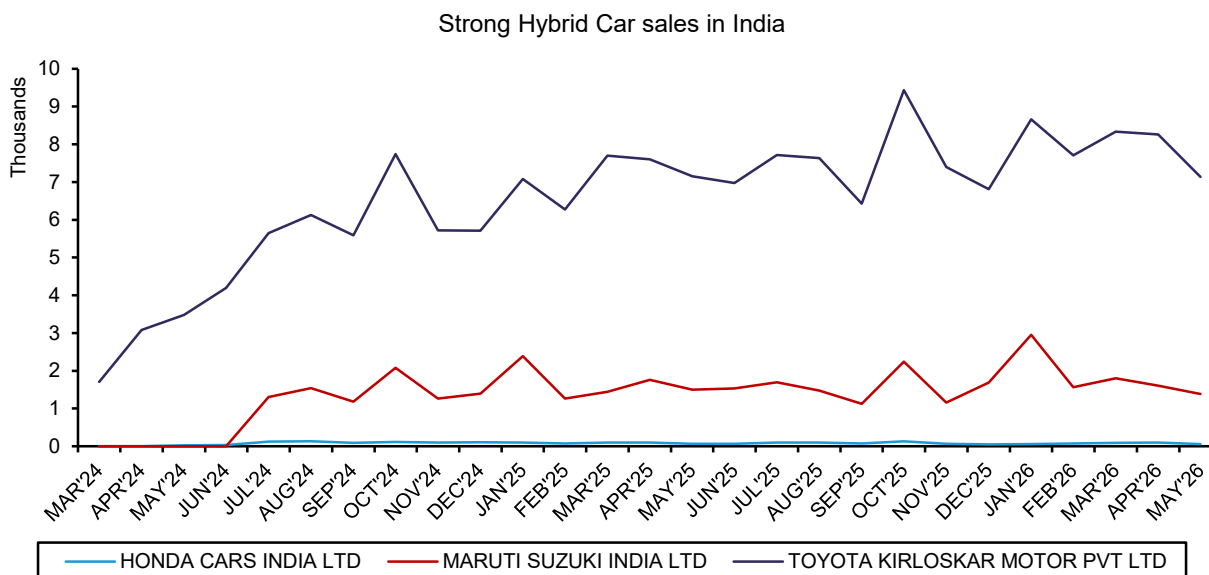
EXHIBIT 2: India's strong hybrid retail volumes grew ~85% in CY25, against a stable count of model catalog



Source: Vahan, Company data, Bernstein analysis

In 2025, with 8 strong-hybrid models on sale against more than 35-40 EVs, hybrid sales grew 83%. One could argue the growth flatters the picture three ways: it is off a low base; it is a Toyota number, not a market number; and it is concentrated in two SUV-MPV body styles that happen to be where India's money is moving regardless. Each is partly true. Toyota holds north of 80% of the segment. The Innova Hycross and Hyryder alone are roughly three-quarters of all hybrid volume.

EXHIBIT 3: Toyota sells ~80% of Strong Hybrids in India, but Maruti's volumes have also picked up since the last 2 years



Source: Vahan, Bernstein analysis

But every one of those objections is itself a catalog fact. Toyota's 80% share is not evidence that only Toyota buyers want hybrids; it is evidence that, until recently, only Toyota was selling them at scale. The clinching data point is Maruti which has also seen its volume pickup by more than 10% YoY (CY24 to CY25) especially in Premium SUVs since those are built on the same Toyota platform and that matters. Maruti also kept its top trims as hybrid only with additional features that are not available on other trims; and demand did appear. We like their strategy.

EXHIBIT 4: Victoris feature sheet handed to us by the dealer: Top trim (ZXI+) is Hybrid only and within the top trim, several premium features (HUD, ventilated seats, ambient lighting, ADAS) are Hybrid-exclusive. Maruti uses this feature unlock to sell Hybrids, in addition to the fuel-efficiency choice.

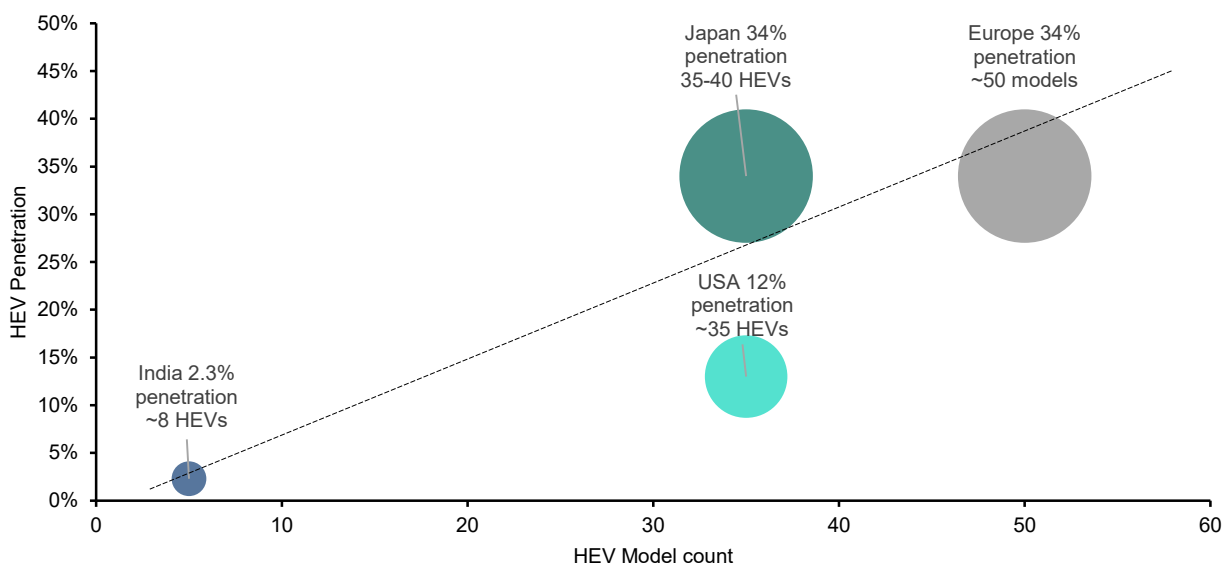
Variantwise Features			
LXI	VXI	ZXI/ZXi(O)	ZXi+/ZXi+(O)
Halogen Projectors Headlamps	Gear Shift Indicators (MT Petrol only)	Dynamic Connected LED Tail Lamps	LED Projectors Headlamps
Halogen Positioning Lamps	Electronic Stability Program	Body Coloured ORVMs	LED Positioning Lamps
LED Rear Combination Lamps (with LED Indicators)	Traction Control System	Body Coloured Outside Door Handles	LED DRLs - Dual Function
Steel Wheels with Full Wheel Covers	Engine Drag Control	Roof Rails	Auto Head Lamp with Follow-Me-Home Function
Chrome Front Grill Garnish	ABS with EBD & Brake Assist	Chrome Inside Door Handles	Black Painted Alloy Wheels
Silver Skid Plate (Front & Rear)	Hill Hold Assist	Glove Box Light	Front Grill Satin Chrome
ORVMs with Turn Indicators	Rear Parking Sensor	Front Footwell Light (Dr. & Co-Dr.)	Grey Skid Plate (Front & Rear) (only Strong Hybrid)
Roof & Quarter Spoiler	6 Airbags	Luggage Room Lamp	All Door Gloss Black Out Tape
Rear Defogger	Front Seat Belt Pre-tensioner & Force Limiter	26.03cm (10.25 inches) TFT MID (only Strong Hybrid)	Front Door UV Cut Glasses
Shark Fin Antenna	Front Seat Belt Height Adjuster	Driver Seat Height Adjuster	Rear Door Dark Green Glass
Aero Vents & Aero Edges	All Seat Belts with 3-point ELR	Front Seat Back Pocket	Front Variable Intermittent Wipers
LED High Mounted Stop Lamps	ISOFIX Child Seat Anchorages	USB Charger Rear Type C+C (45W+45W) (max 60W)	Rear Wiper & Washer
Dual Tone Interior (Black + Ivory) with Silver Accents	Engine Immobiliser	Luggage Room Accessory Socket	All Black Interior with Champagne Gold Accents (Only Strong Hybrid)
Door Trim & IP Garnish (Piano Black)	Tyre Repair Kit	PM 2.5 Cabin Air Filter	Soft Touch IP with Premium Stitch - (Black & Ivory - Petrol, Black - Strong Hybrid)
Black Door Trim Armrest Fabric	Day & Night IRVM	Electrically Foldable ORVMs	Door Trim Armrest (Ivory+ PVC Stitch - Petrol & CNG)
Rear Reading Lamps	17.78cm Smartplay Pro Touch Screen	Vanity Mirror (Driver + Co Driver)	Door Trim Armrest (Black+ PVC Stitch - Strong Hybrid)
10.66cm (4.2inches) TFT MID	Wireless Apple Carplay & Android Auto	Cruise Control	Smart Powered Tailgate with Gesture Control
60:40 Rear Split Seats	OTA Updates	Paddle Shifters (AT Only)	Panoramic Sunroof (only optional variant)
All Seats Adjustable Headrests	2 Door Speakers	Engine Drive Mode (Eco, Normal, Sport) - Strong Hybrid	Wireless Charger with Active Cooling
Type A Front Charger	Steering Mounted Controls	Electronic Parking Brake with Brake Hold (Only 6AT)	Auto Day & Night IRVM
Accessory Socket (Center Console)	AC Temperature Display & Control on Screen	Reverse Parking Camera	LED Front Foglamps with Extending Light
Push Start with Smart Key		Tyre Pressure Monitoring System (TPMS)	Panoramic Sunroof (only optional variant)
Auto AC		Acoustic Vehicle Alert System (Only Strong Hybrid)	
Pollen Cabin Air Filter		Next Gen Suzuki Connect with 60+ Connected Car Features	
Rear AC Vents		Front Two Tweeters	
Front Sliding Armrest with Utility Space			
Rear Center Armrest with Cup Holder			
Tilt & Telescopic Power Steering			
Keyless Entry			

Top trim only strong hybrid.
[ADAS as well on top trim]

Source: Channel checks, Company Data, Bernstein analysis

Step back to the cross-country view and the relationship stops being arguable. Hybrid penetration tracks the size of the catalog almost everywhere you look - Japan at ~34% off ~35-40 models, Europe at ~35% off 50-60 line-ups that span nearly every nameplate, the US at ~12-13% off 35-40 models. India sits alone in the bottom-left corner of the chart, at ~2.3% off 8 models. As we show in Exhibit 2, India is not a different kind of market. It is the same kind of market with the fewest doors.

EXHIBIT 5: More doors, more buyers: Hybrid penetration tracks the size of the catalogue, and India has by far the fewest doors. Model counts are estimates; the relationship is not

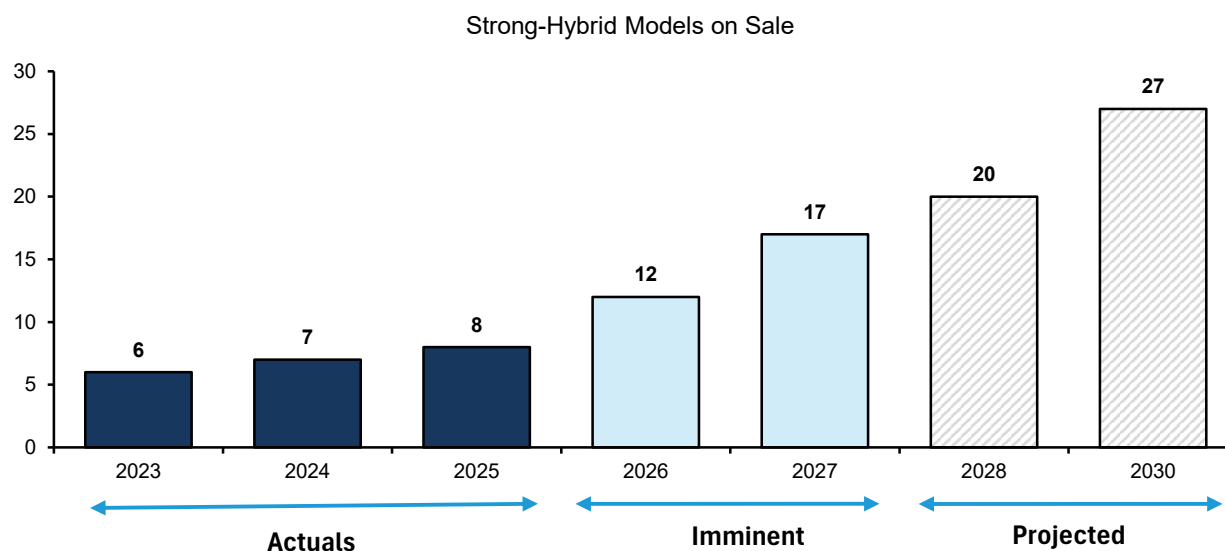


Source: SNE, News articles, Vahan, Bernstein Analysis

THE CATALOG DOUBLES IN THE NEXT EIGHTEEN MONTHS

If the segment's size is set by its catalog, then the single most important fact about India's hybrid market is that the catalog is about to change shape. The upcoming launch wave is not a rumour or a roadmap slide - it is a dense, front-loaded cohort of confirmed and advanced-stage programmes, and it is concentrated exactly where the volume is.

EXHIBIT 6: India will go from 8 strong-hybrid nameplates in 2025 to roughly 27 by 2030; expansion led by Hyundai's confirmed 8 by 2030 plan, Maruti's in-house series-HEV programme, and a wave of Korean, Japanese and Indian launches in 2026-27. The 2026-27 step-up is the inflection.



Hyundai Motor India (not covered)

Source: Company Data, News Articles, Bernstein analysis

And it is worth being concrete about which models, in which price bands, are coming. The map below places every confirmed and probable hybrid by brand and by on-road price band - the level at which the Indian buyer actually transacts. The black cells are the existing bench. The purple cells are confirmed planned launches. The red cells are advanced-stage probable launches. The pattern is unmistakable: the wave clusters in the Mid (Belly) bands - 15–25 lakh on-road - which is precisely the heart of the Indian PV market.

EXHIBIT 7: The catalog, drawn out by on-road price. 3 Maruti existing strong hybrids (Victoris, Grand Vitara, Invicto), 4 Toyota nameplates and a single Honda anchor the bench today. Six brands cluster into the 1.5-3 mn on-road band over FY28. Dates and prices are press-reported; placement uses indicative on-road pricing.

Brand	Entry		Mid (Belly)		Premium		Super Premium	
	<₹1 mn	₹1-1.5 mn	₹1.5-2 mn	₹2-2.5 mn	₹2.5-3 mn	₹3-4 mn	₹4-5 mn	>₹5 mn
Toyota			Hyryder		Innova Hycross		Camry	Vellfire
Maruti			Victoris hybrid	Grand Vitara		Invicto		
		Fronx hybrid		GV 7-seater				
	YDB MPV	Swift / Baleno HEV						
Honda				City e:HEV				
				Elevate e:HEV		ZR-V e:HEV		CR-V e:HEV
Hyundai				Creta hybrid	NiLi 3-row			Palisade hybrid
Kia				Seltos hybrid				
Renault				Duster E-Tech				
Nissan				Tekton hybrid				
Mahindra		XUV 3XO hybrid			BE 6 (REx)	XEV 9e (REx)		
Skoda-VW		Kylaq hybrid						

On sale today
 Confirmed planned
 Probable / under study
 Bands are on-road price.

Source: News Articles, Company Data, Bernstein analysis

The caveat: Indian launch timing slips, and this list has slipped already - the Fronx hybrid alone has wandered from 2025 to 2027 as Maruti wrestled the hardware into a sub-4m body. Treat every date here as indicative. What does not slip is the direction. Half a dozen makers who sat out the segment are now building into it at once, and they are not doing it on a hunch - they are doing it because CAFE-III compliance from April 2027 effectively requires an electrified bench, and a self-charging hybrid is the cheapest one to build.

The part that changes the segment's shape, not merely its size, is the in-house series-hybrid. Until now a strong hybrid in India meant a Toyota system in a 25 lakh SUV. Maruti's homegrown series-HEV - a small petrol engine acting purely as a generator, architecturally closer to Nissan's ePower than to Toyota's power-split - is designed to deliver 35+ kmpl without the licensing cost, in cars that sell below 15 lakh ex-showroom. That is the difference between adding models to a premium niche and opening the segment to the mass market. The catalog does not just get longer in FY27/28. It gets cheaper too!

THE TAX WALL, AND HENCE THE PRICE GAP IS REAL

EVs are taxed at 5% and strong hybrids (>4m) at 40%, small hybrids (≤4m) at 18% - at par with ICE vehicles. That gap is the defining feature of the regime, and it is slightly opposite of the market where the global hybrid takeoff actually happened. There, hybrids received favourable treatment - Japan's eco-car programme from 2009 cut acquisition and weight taxes to near-zero for non-plug HEVs, Korea followed the same logic, offering consumption tax reductions for strong HEVs, reaching 24% hybrid penetration by 2024.

In India, state policy could be the wild card, but the lesson there is graduated. Uttar Pradesh's 2024 road-tax waiver cut on-road hybrid prices and briefly turned the state into one of India's largest hybrid markets - proof of how violently volumes respond to price. Then it lapsed in October 2025 and sales slowed at once - proof that state waivers are a catalyst, not a foundation. We treat them as high-beta and low-durability: a renewal in UP, or a Maharashtra or Karnataka following suit, could be volume

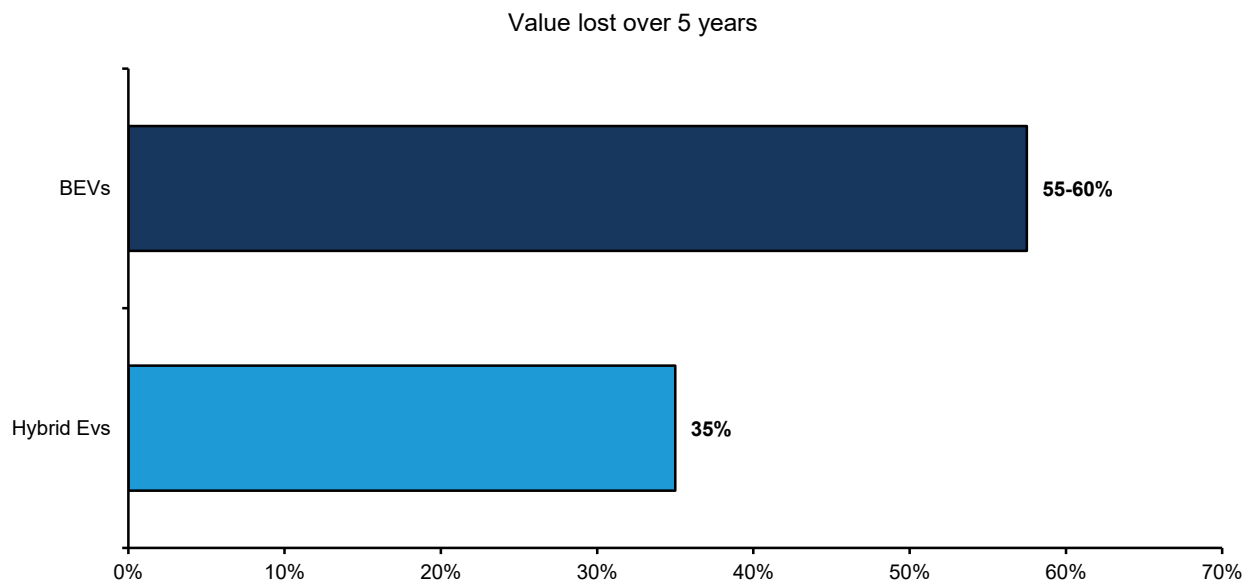
catalyst; a Chhattisgarh-style exclusion is the bear case. Neither belongs in the base case.

That leaves the two policy debates that actually bound the thesis. CAFE-III, from April 2027, cut the strong-hybrid super-credit from 2.0 to 1.6 while leaving EVs at 3 - a real tilt toward BEVs, but a modest erosion of hybrid compliance value, and one that still leaves hybrids earning their keep. And NITI Aayog continues to hold the ZEV-only line, declining so far to widen the definition to include hybrids, with a lifecycle-emissions study still pending. The thesis does not require any of this to break the hybrids' way. It requires only that the wall stay roughly where it is while the catalog fills in behind it. On current policy, that is precisely the base case - and CAFE-III, for all its EV tilt, is itself the reason Maruti and Mahindra are building hybrids at all.

RESIDUAL VALUES AND ACCORDINGLY THE TCO STRENGTHEN THE HYBRID CASE

The TCO debate in India is conducted almost entirely on fuel cost, and that leaves out one of the largest numbers in the calculation. Over five years, the average BEV loses 60% of its value; the average hybrid loses 35%. On a 40 lakh-equivalent vehicle that gap is worth more than the fuel savings the EV was supposed to deliver. Residual value is a quietly large variable in the total-cost picture, and it points the same way the charging map does.

EXHIBIT 8: Over five years the average BEV loses two-thirds more of its value than the average hybrid - a line item the running-cost debate often leaves out



Source: iSeeCars, News Articles, Bernstein analysis and estimates

Now the complication, because the hybrid case is not a clean sweep on running cost. On the Grand Vitara, independent testing puts the hybrid's breakeven against the mild-hybrid past 1.1 lakh kms (or 5 years, if car drives 60kms each day), and CNG - at roughly 3/km against the hybrid's 3.5 - is genuinely cheaper to run, boot space permitting. For a low-mileage private buyer choosing on fuel alone, the strong hybrid does not obviously win today. That is the truth, and it is why today's hybrid is a high-mileage and fleet proposition more than a universal one.

EXHIBIT 9: The strong hybrid commands a INR 0.3-0.5mn on-road premium over its Smart Hybrid equivalent - a gap that requires >100K kms to recover on fuel alone, making the proposition fleet- and high-mileage-skewed at current prices

Victoris Variant (ascending order)	Powertrain	On road Price (INR millions)
LXI	CNG	1.42
VXI	CNG	1.57
	Smart Hybrid	1.67
	Strong Hybrid	2
ZXI	CNG	1.77
	Smart Hybrid	1.88
	Strong Hybrid	2.2
ZXI+	Smart Hybrid	2.2
	Strong Hybrid	2.4

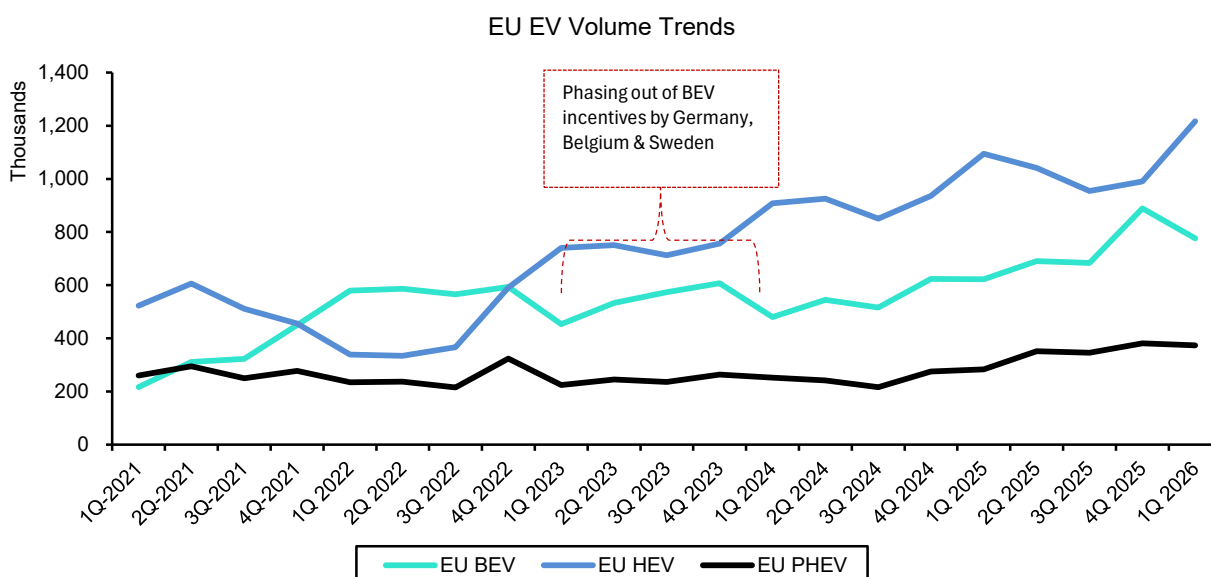
Source: Channel checks, Secondary Data, Bernstein analysis and estimates

Which is exactly why the two forces in this note compound. Drop the upfront premium with the in-house series-HEV, and the breakeven that looks unreachable on a 20 lakh SUV becomes ordinary on a 12 lakh one. Layer on a used-car market that is formalising fast - Spinny, Cars24, OEM-certified programmes - which rewards exactly the predictable residuals hybrids offer and punishes the volatility BEVs have shown. India has already had its cautionary tale: the BluSmart collapse put EV fleet-residual risk on the front page. The residual argument is not a side-note to the hybrid case. For the private buyer, it may be the case.

WHAT THE WORLD TELLS US - AND WHAT IT DOESN'T

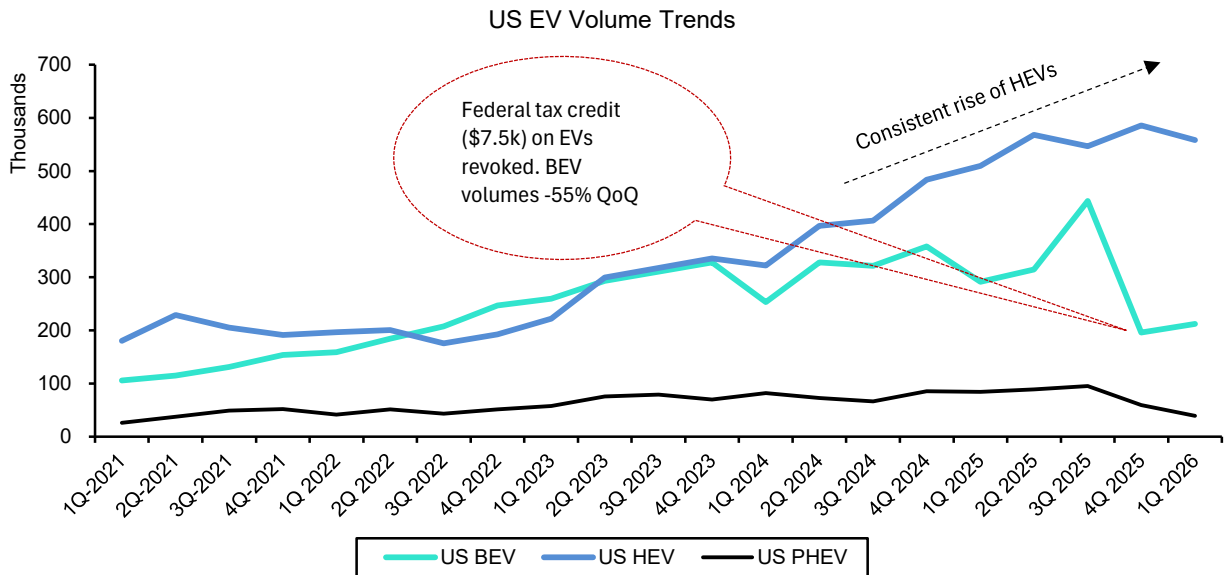
The global tape looks, at first glance, like an unqualified endorsement. As EV subsidies were pulled, hybrids out-accelerated pure BEVs across every major Western market and Japan, while plug-in hybrids and range-extenders drove China's entire NEV surge. However, the read-across cuts both ways, and the honest version is more useful than the triumphant one.

EXHIBIT 10: When BEV subsidies were withdrawn across key EU markets, strong hybrids and not PHEVs absorbed displaced demand, now exceeding 1.2mn units/quarter and outpacing BEVs; Europe is India's upside scenario.



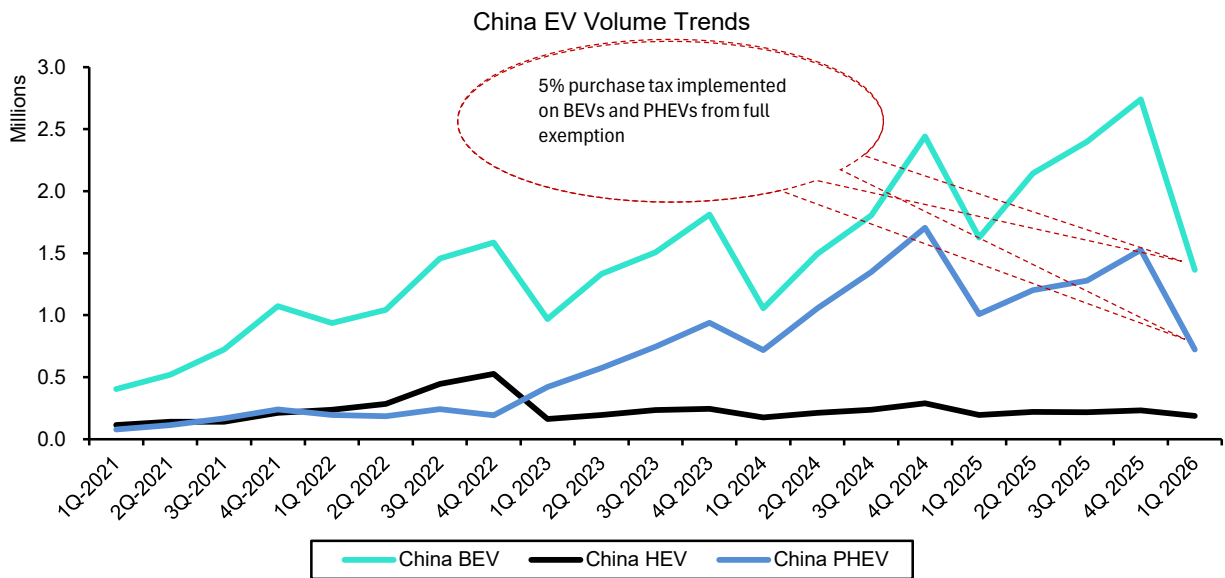
Source: SNE Research, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 11: The revocation of the \$7,500 EV tax credit sent BEV volumes down ~55% QoQ; HEVs held firm at ~575k/quarter, demonstrating that buyers re-price rather than abandon electrification - the most direct analogue for India's mass-market consumer.



Source: SNE Research, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 12: China: HEVs flatlined not by consumer choice but by policy design - Beijing's deliberate exclusion of strong hybrids from green plates and tax breaks is the downside bookend for India's hybrid market.



Source: SNE Research, Bernstein analysis

Two readings matter. The bullish one is the US, EU and Japan: where charging is thin, fuel is dear and subsidies fade, buyers reach for the hybrid, and they do so on economics and familiarity rather than mandate. That is India's fundamental profile almost exactly. The cautionary one is China - and it is the more instructive. Strong, non-plug hybrids were not rejected by Chinese consumers; they were legislated out. Beijing denied HEVs the green plates, the purchase-tax break and the licence-plate exemptions it handed BEVs and plug-ins, and the segment simply never formed. The lesson is sobering: a determined government can make a viable powertrain disappear by withholding status from it.

So we use these as scenario bookends, not templates. The upside bookend is a US/Japan path where economics and a filling catalog carry hybrids to high-single or low-double-digit share. The downside bookend is a China-style outcome where India's BEV-first central policy hardens, the catalog is allowed to stay thin, and the segment is capped by fiat. India is structurally different from all four - not immune to any of them. That is precisely why the catalog, the one variable producers control directly, is the swing factor rather than policy, which they don't.

WHERE THINGS COULD GO THE OTHER WAY ROUND

A upside case on hybrid is only worth holding if you can state the downside case that would break it, in the same plain language. Here is ours, and we do not think it is weak. The genuine threat is not the tax wall - it is the BEV cost curve. If Chinese-style battery economics arrive in India through BYD (covered by Eunice Lee), MG (part of SAIC group covered by Eunice Lee) and a re-energised Tata (not covered), the EV's sticker premium narrows, its running-cost edge holds, and the hybrid's sweet spot - the gap it occupies between expensive BEVs and dirty ICE - closes from the EV side. The early signs are not nothing: EU BEV registrations re-accelerated in the second half of 2025, and Chinese BEVs out-grew plug-in hybrids in 2025 for the first time in three years.

But to argue against, do you think the 5% rate on EVs and the road tax exemptions are of a constant nature? We don't think so. It is a policy choice, and it will not survive forever if BEV volumes become large enough to hurt state finances. Karnataka has just shown how. Faced with a ~INR 21 billion revenue shortfall in FY25-26 - with EV exemptions cited as a contributing cause - the state ended its full EV road-tax exemption from April 2026 and re-introduced a tiered 5/8/10% lifetime tax. Kerala moved similarly earlier in 2025, hitting EVs over 1.5 million with 8% and over 2million with 10%. The 5% central GST rate is sticky, but the effective EV tax burden is the central rate plus state choices - and the state choices have begun to drift the other way. As BEV adoption grows, the pressure to claw back exemptions grows with it. We do not expect the "effective" price gap between EVs and ICE to narrow meaningfully before 2030. The bear case from BEV cost compression is real; it is also bounded.

Three further risks deserve naming and sizing. Charging build-out, if it scales faster than we assume, erodes the no-charging-anxiety advantage that anchors the hybrid case. Policy can harden rather than hold - more states adopting the Chhattisgarh exclusion, or a NITI lifecycle study that rules against hybrids, would each tighten the cap. And rare-earth magnet supply is a shared constraint that hits hybrids and EVs alike, though it modestly favours hybrids on absolute magnet content per vehicle. None of these is fatal on its own; together, in a downside case, they keep hybrids stuck at 3-5% rather than climbing to our 7-8%.

This is why we bound the call. We are bullish on the strong-hybrid segment, and on Maruti as its cleanest expression, through the back half of this decade - the window in which the FY27/28/28 catalog fills in and BEV cost parity has not yet arrived. Beyond 2030 the picture is genuinely two-sided, and we will not pretend to see through it. It also means the largest piece of hybrid capex on the table - Toyota's 200 billion Maharashtra plant, Maruti's new hybrid lines - carries real terminal-value risk if the window closes early. We are positive for five years. We are not positive forever, and a note that claimed otherwise would deserve less trust, not more.

THE TRADE

Strip everything else away and one variable decides this. Not the tax rate, which is hostile but stable. Not consumer appetite, which eight models have already demonstrated. The catalog. It roughly doubles from FY28. That is the whole thesis, and it is why we are positive - bounded, but positive - on the segment and on the names levered to it.

We expect strong-hybrid penetration to climb from ~2.3% (in CY25) toward 7-8% of passenger vehicles by 2030, behind BEVs on policy support but ahead on TCO and residuals. Within our coverage, Maruti Suzuki is the cleanest expression of that view - it owns much of the FY28 catalog, its in-house series-HEV is the price unlock, and its multi-fuel mix means it wins whichever powertrain prevails. Mahindra is the higher-variance call - hedged through the XUV 3XO hybrid and INGLO range-extendors, but exposed by an EV-first posture it has argued too loudly to abandon cheaply.

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 13: Maruti Suzuki Financial Summary

P&L (Rs mn)	FY26A	FY27E	FY28E	Balance sheet	FY26A	FY27E	FY28E
Revenue	1,832,661	2,043,919	2,232,218	Fixed assets	826,295	926,295	1,026,295
EBITDA	214,502	232,034	260,532	Cash and equivalents	457,241	573,611	714,097
EBIT	147,097	142,979	160,477	Net debt/(funds)	(751,157)	(867,527)	(1,008,013)
Other income	43,919	53,404	61,752	Shareholders' equity	1,051,098	1,154,519	1,277,369
Pretax income	188,629	193,997	219,842	Current assets	389,112	436,147	563,194
Tax	44,175	46,559	52,762	Current liabilities	364,772	370,621	404,765
Net income	144,454	147,437	167,080	Change in WC	16,375	45,184	17,583
EPS (adjusted)	459.46	468.95	531.43	CFO	190,631	230,659	225,352
EPS (reported)	459.46	468.95	531.43	Capital expenditure	(103,964)	(100,000)	(100,000)
Diluted shares (mn)	314	314	314	FCFF	86,667	130,659	125,352
DPS (Rs)	140	141	159	BVPS	3,343	3,672	4,063
Key ratios/metrics	FY26A	FY27E	FY28E	Operating metrics	FY26A	FY27E	FY28E
Revenue growth	19.9%	11.5%	9.2%	Total volumes ('000)	2,423	2,605	2,744
PAT growth	0.7%	2.1%	13.3%	Domestic Cars	922	968	968
EBITDA margin	11.7%	11.4%	11.7%	Domestic UVs	761	799	855
EBIT margin	8.0%	7.0%	7.2%	Domestic Vans	140	141	144
Pre-tax margin	10.3%	9.5%	9.8%	Domestic LCV	39	39	40
PAT margin	7.9%	7.2%	7.5%	Total domestic	1,862	1,948	2,007
Tax	23.4%	24.0%	24.0%	Exports	448	524	587
ROE	13.7%	12.8%	13.1%	Realisation per car (Rs)	719,758	748,548	778,490
ROE(ex-cash)	19.1%	18.9%	22.0%				

Source: Company Data, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 14: M&M Financial Summary

P&L (Rs mn)	FY26A	FY27E	FY28E	Balance Sheet	FY26A	FY27E	FY28E
Revenue	1,455,758	1,604,602	1,803,423	Fixed assets	559,341	654,341	749,341
EBITDA	209,775	246,681	278,638	Cash and equivalents	335,864	435,082	564,566
EBIT	166,848	194,444	218,986	Net debt/(funds)	(193,619)	(292,837)	(422,321)
Other Income	41,890	49,277	57,301	Shareholders' equity	734,976	875,488	1,035,000
Pre-tax income	206,242	241,678	274,358	Current assets	623,614	752,253	921,037
Tax	49,498	56,794	64,474	Current liabilities	399,929	440,820	495,441
Net income (adj)	156,744	184,884	209,884	Change in WC	30,011	11,470	15,321
EPS (adj)	126.0	148.6	168.6	CFO	190,288	201,357	229,485
EPS (reported)	126.0	148.6	168.6	Capital expenditure	(85,000)	(95,000)	(95,000)
Diluted shares (mn)	1,244	1,244	1,245	Free cash flow	95,288	96,357	124,485
DPS (R)	30.2	35.7	40.5	BVPS	591	704	831
Key ratios/metrics	FY26A	FY27E	FY28E	Key metrics	FY26A	FY27E	FY28E
Revenue growth	25.0%	10.2%	12.4%	Auto segment revenue	1,093,549	1,208,332	1,370,687
PAT growth	32.2%	18.0%	13.5%	Growth YoY (%)	25%	10%	13%
EBITDA margin	13.1%	14.4%	15.4%	Farm segment revenue	364,093	398,249	434,814
EBIT margin	32.1%	20.0%	20.0%	Growth YoY (%)	25%	9%	9%
Pre-tax margin	13.7%	14.2%	15.1%	Automotive volumes	1,156,346	1,237,213	1,349,938
PAT margin	10.9%	10.8%	11.5%	Growth YoY (%)	21%	7%	9%
Tax	20.5%	24.0%	23.5%	Tractor volumes	520,554	556,798	595,773
ROE	20.5%	21.3%	21.1%	Growth YoY (%)	18%	7%	7%
ROE(ex-cash)	20.4%	31.9%	34.1%				

Source: Company Data, Bernstein analysis and estimates

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Maruti Suzuki India Ltd**

We arrive at our price target of INR18,200 for Maruti Suzuki on DCF (10.5% wacc, 4% terminal growth, FY35 terminal year, 7% volume estimates, 10% ebitda cagr) and the price target implies a P/E multiple of 31x FY28E earnings. A 12% earnings CAGR is estimated from FY26-28E.

Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd

To arrive at our Rs 4,200 price target, we value M&M on a sum of the parts' basis with its standalone + MVML (ex S&A dividends) business valued at 21.6x FY27/28E. We value the listed subsidiaries, financial services, Tech Mahindra, and auto comps subsidiary at market cap and then apply a holding company discount of 20%. In addition, we value the 92% stake which is valued at \$10bn.

RISKS**Maruti Suzuki India Ltd**

Downside risks to our price target include 1) Slowdown in overall PV demand, 2) Significant increase in new competitors due to the new EV policy, 3) Massive increase in commodity prices, especially Steel and 4) Inability to recover share due to lack of traction in the new launches remains a risk

Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd

Downside risk emerges from slower-than-expected recovery tractors industry growth and/or market share loss for M&M. A weak monsoon season will also impact the performance of tractors. Failure to improve margins for the automotive business also poses risk.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION**EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS****Bernstein brand**

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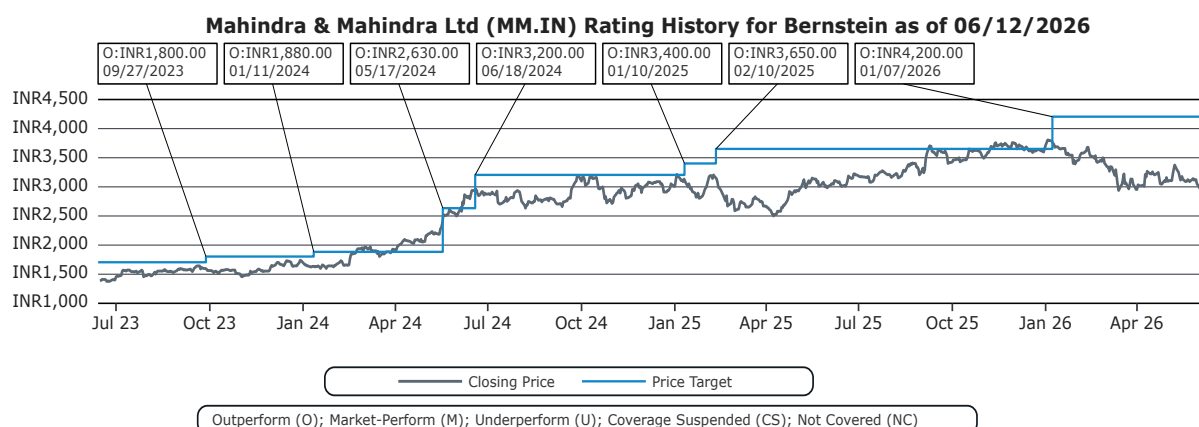
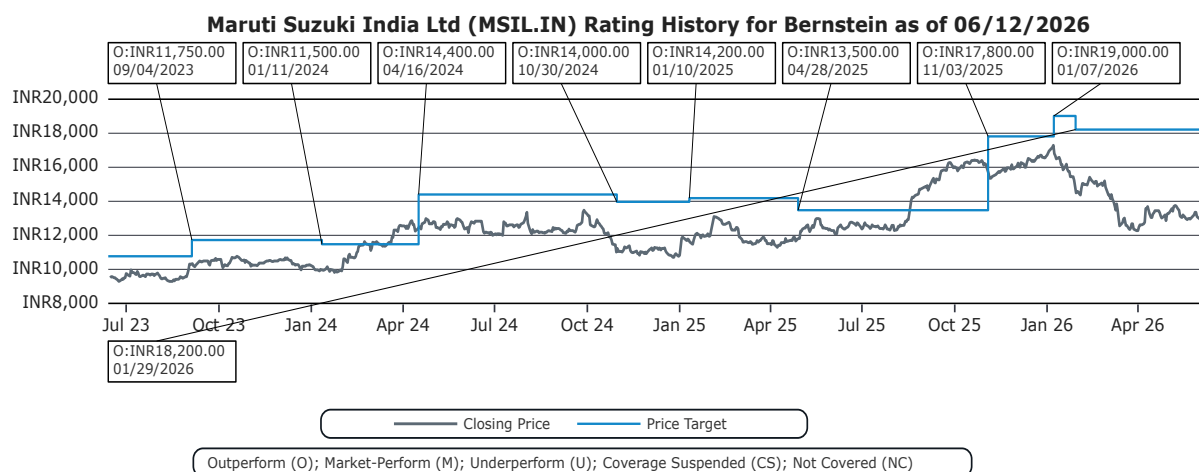
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Underperform	SELL	12.6%	14.9%

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